



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRAICAIN DES ETUDIANTS
UNIÃO DOS ESTUDANTES DE TODA A ÁFRICA
اتحاد طلاب عموم إفريقيا

AASU S - CLIM PROJECT





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Promoting Waste Management Culture for Better Climate
Conditions Through Social Media Influence



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The importance of maintaining a clean and serene climate in our towns and neighborhoods cannot be overstated; the poor sanitation records prevailing on the continent, coupled with the plastic trash menace, makes this reality very obvious. This project will be aimed at educating people on how they can use social media to help fight climate change and the actions they can take as individuals. Our immediate target audience encompasses the 170 million students on the continent of Africa and roll-off onto the general public.

PROBLEM STATEMENT FOR GHANA ONLY



-  Solid waste's organic component, which is biodegradable, might not pose too much of an issue. However, because it is non-biodegradable and can dwell in the environment for a long time, generating all kinds of issues, the plastic waste component of solid waste constitutes a significant environmental challenge in Ghana.
-  Ghana now disposes of plastic waste by burning it and burying it in the ground, both of which are harmful to the environment. Since the former could release carbon dioxide, a significant contributor to global warming, it is not sustainable or environmentally beneficial (greenhouse effect). The latter is equally undesirable because plastic cannot be degraded.
-  According to research made by GOPA Consultants in Accra Ghana, 1983, plastic garbage makes up 1-5 percent (of net weight) of all waste produced (Lardinois and Van de Klundert, 1995).
-  Statistics released by the AMA Waste Management Department and other waste management bodies indicate that about 9000 tons of waste is generated daily, out of which 315 tons are plastic related (Amankwah, 2005).
-  In Ghana, drinking water comes in plastic bags and not bottles. These bags now constitute a major proportion of the plastic waste generated throughout the country.
-  Plastics have replaced leaves, glass and metals as a cheaper and more efficient means of packaging (IRIN, 2006).
-  Almost all the major gutters in Accra are currently choked with plastic waste and this has resulted in floods, loss of property and in Ghana recording high rate of malaria and cholera even in the 21st century.
-  The whole country is gradually being swallowed up by the plastic waste menace that the Ghana government had to declare a recycling war on plastic waste in 2004. This is what was said by the then minister for Local government, 'we expect recycling to create a healthy environment for tourists, create jobs and save foreign exchange in imports of drugs to fight cholera and malaria that may result from the rubbish heaps' (IRIN, 2006).

But not much work has been done in this area thus far. Therefore, it would be best for the environment and sustainable living if the plastic waste problem were addressed as soon as possible.



WHY RECYCLING

Given the following advantages, recycling plastic trash appears to be the most effective way to address Ghana's plastic waste problem:

Plastics Recycling Reduces Landfill Space

Recycling plastic products prevents them from ending up in landfills and enables their reuse in the production of new goods. 7.4 cubic yards of landfill area are spared for every ton of recycled plastic.

Waste Reduction

The strength and inertness of plastics are what make them so valuable. Plastics are long-lasting. Unfortunately, because of their strength, they decompose in landfills quite slowly. Plastics can dissolve more quickly when they enter the environment, such as the ocean, but they still take a long time to biodegrade; for instance, a plastic bottle may take a century to degrade, whereas a plastic beverage holder may take four centuries.

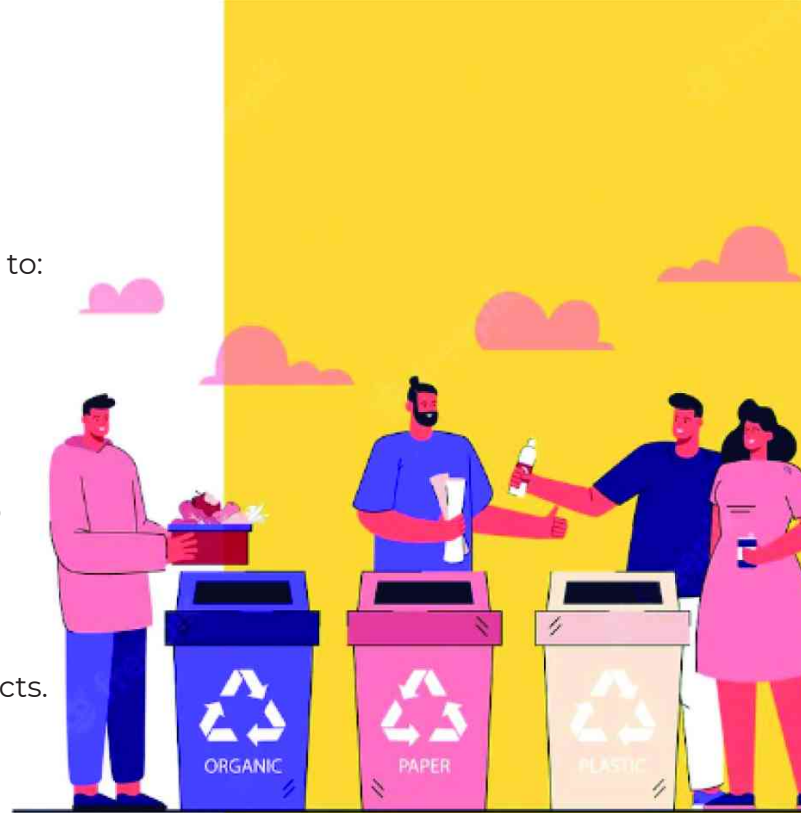
WHAT ACTIVITIES WILL YOU UNDERTAKE?

-  Hosting seminars will be the headline activity to ensure our message is heard. It will give us the opportunity of an audience to educate and engage the public on the topic. We will use this opportunity to visit institutions such as Technical Universities, Universities, various Senior High Schools, Churches, Mosques.
-  Social Media packs dissemination, they must respond to answers like "why I should participate," "what can I do to help," and many more.
-  Media Partnerships; a constant media partner who will facilitate documentaries, radio shows, billboards and tv shows and Seminars. The proposed guest speaker, Kwadwo Sheldon is a Ghanaian content creator on YouTube and a social media influencer. And other important speakers.
-  Petition signing; this will help document public support in our campaign
-  Parliamentary engagements, this will culminate to legislative action
-  Key Ministerial engagements i.e., Education, ICT, Health and Media
-  Civil Society engagement
-  Community Engagement i.e., equipped community centers
-  Campaign brand Ambassadors (Influencers, Teachers and Students)
-  Learning Materials: We will create and develop educational material on recycling, aiming to design interesting media that are engaging for various audiences. With constant improvements, our content is made available in many languages with the goal of utilizing these educational materials globally and making them available on all social media platforms.
-  Event to Climax

OUR GOAL

The major goal of this Recycling Project is to:

- Educate the people
- Reduce the plastic waste menace in our environment
- Make our cities clean and serene to prevent any epidemic
- Reduce the importation of plastic products as well as the cost of manufacturing virgin plastic products.



PROGRESS TRACKING

Having already established the goals and what this project aims to achieve, we have a few points to consider to enable easy progress tracking. We believe that not only do we have to educate, but we must be intentional in making this change a reality. A few ways by which we can keep track of this positive change is;

- Sharing before and after pictures and videos as proof of cleanup progress. This will help us monitor the progress of the project and re-strategize where need be, to drive this project to success.
- **Social Media and Traditional Media.**
Series of edited videos and artworks will be created and developed to help in educating the public. These videos and artworks will be starred on social media with a proposed hashtag (#cleanupghana4all) and traditional media platforms such as television stations.
- Jingle/Soundtrack will be developed both in English and in Twi to be played on radio and announcement speakers in our local communities.

BELIEFS

We have common beliefs that we hope will transcend to the general public as we embark on this educational journey. We believe educating the public on proper disposal, proper collection and proper recycling. We use the word 'proper' to signify "taking a closer look, developing measuring mechanism to monitor the progress of waste collection and management."

WHO ARE WE?

The All-Africa Students Union is a non-governmental organisation duly incorporated under the Companies Act 1963 (Act 179) of Ghana. Since its inception in 1972 in Ghana, AASU now has a presence in 54 Countries in Africa. The Union played an essential role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid in South Africa. Today, AASU is at the forefront of the fights for equal access to quality education, quality assurance in higher education, harmonization of higher education systems – with crucial emphasis on the mobility of academics and comparability of qualifications, democratic governance, defending students' rights, promotion of gender and African culture, sustainable development, entrepreneurship, fostering of academic freedom, freedom of research and autonomy of higher institutions of learning, and the promotion of peace and democratic values, and other noteworthy objectives. The organisation, in collaboration with the Organising Bureau of School Student Unions (OBESSU), European Students' Union (ESU), Commonwealth Students' Association (CSA) and 100 million, is running an advocacy campaign to demand justice for every child. In addition, the organisation collaborated with the Association of African Universities to undertake the African Student Olympics in Egypt 2019. The Union is wholly student-run and student-led, autonomous, representative, and operates according to democratic principles. The executives of the Union are democratically elected and representative of all the sub-regions across the Continent.

AASU exists to create among the broad masses of African people a sense of awareness of the problems confronting the continent and the need for students as an integral part of their society to be fully involved in all endeavors. AASU seeks to continuously improve on the creation of timely opportunities for African students to contribute to solving the problems of the continent and meeting / exceeding the expectations of educational stakeholders and development partners by providing accurate and timely information about students on the Continent.

AASU seeks to be a leading organisation in mobilizing, co-coordinating, and involving African students in all the efforts geared towards Africa's socio-economic, political and cultural advancement.

AASU is known for its ability to see projects and programmes to fruition within the shortest time. This could be attributed to the organisation's grassroots mobilizing capacity and its membership cuts across student groups on the Continent at the national and regional levels. In recent years, AASU has been vibrant in open society initiatives in the areas of education and justice through their Education Enrolment Programme aimed at putting children who are of school-going age but are not in school back to school to gain essential and literacy skills and campaigning to demand that the rights of children and young people, especially the most marginalized, are protected during and post COVID-19.

AASU derives its credibility from the member unions within the 54 African countries where the organisation has its presence. It is through its membership that AASU has held continental programs in countries like Sudan, Rwanda, Morocco, Kenya and Ghana successfully.

AASU gets a chunk of its funding from subventions from the Government of Ghana and annual dues paid by its member unions. Therefore, AASU has the needed human resource and the mobilization capacity to carry out the proposed project coupled with the organisation's close relationship with student bodies and unions.



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